1.1.1 — Theories of Obedience

Student Notes Workbook · 学习笔记工作册

agency theory（代理理论）· social power theory（社会权力理论）

Name 姓名: _____ Class 班级: _____ Start date: _____

How to use this workbook 使用方法

1. **Read one section of the courseware, then fill the matching page.** 边读课件边填空，不要一口气填完——填空的价值在于"想不起来"的那一刻。
2. **Learn the definitions word for word.** 定义本身就是采分点：obedience、agentic state、moral strain、五个 power 的说法都要能原样写出来。
3. **Every evaluation point needs two halves.** 评价 = *理论漏掉了什么* + *为什么这是个问题*。只写前半句是描述，两块一起才是评价。
4. **Check your answers at the back, correct in pen, then do the brain dump page from memory.** 对答案 → 用笔订正 → 合上笔记自测。

What this topic covers 内容地图

Syllabus 考纲	Content 内容	Workbook pages
1.1.1	term social influence · obedience · theory agency theory · theory French & Raven's five bases of power	pp. 2–10
Evaluation 评价	eval strengths and weaknesses of each theory · reductionism · individual differences · situational factors	pp. 6–7, 9–10
Exam skills 考试	exam IDEA for scenario questions · command words · 2 / 6 / 8-mark answers	pp. 11–14
Self-test 自测	Brain dump from memory · answer key	pp. 15–17

The one-line map of the whole topic 全章一句话

Two theories try to explain the **same** event — an ordinary person doing what an authority figure tells them to do:
① theory **agency theory** *看服从的人*：责任从自己身上移走（agentic shift），人一边照做一边承受冲突（moral strain）。
② theory **social power theory** 看 *下命令的人*：对方被*认为*拥有哪种权力（coercive / reward / legitimate / expert / referent）。

Review tracker 复习打卡

- ☐ First pass — all blanks filled 第一遍填完 Date: _____
- ☐ Five bases of power written from memory 五种权力默写 Date: _____
- ☐ Two 8-mark plans written 两篇 8 分题提纲 Date: _____
- ☐ Brain dump done with the book closed 合上笔记完成自测 Date: _____

§1 · Foundations — where this topic sits · 基础定位

ANSWERS → 课件 §2–§4

The approach we are standing in 我们用的研究取向

Psychology explains the same behaviour in several ways; each way is called an **approach**（研究取向）. This topic uses the **social approach**: behaviour is explained by _____.（the real or imagined presence / pressure of others 他人在场或想象中的压力）

The four approaches — one line each 四个取向一句话

Approach	How it explains behaviour 怎么解释行为
Biological（生物）	By biological structures and processes: the brain, the nervous system, hormones and genes.
Cognitive（认知）	By internal mental processes: memory, perception, attention, thinking and language.
Learning（学习）	By experience: what we associate, what we are rewarded or punished for, what we observe.
Social（社会）	By the presence of others, or by their real or imagined pressure. ← **this topic**

Three words used all year 全年都在用的三个词

theory 理论	A set of principles that attempt to _____.（explain behaviour 解释行为）
study 研究	A piece of research carried out to _____ a theory, or to explore behaviour.（test 检验）
methodology 方法学	The method used to _____, and how the study is designed.（collect data 收集数据）

Three forms of social influence 社会影响的三种形式

Form 形式	Who influences whom 谁影响谁	Definition 定义
Conformity（从众）	a _____ → you（majority 多数人）	Opinions, beliefs and/or behaviour influenced by a _____.（majority 多数人）
Minority influence（少数派影响）	a _____ → the majority（minority 少数人）	The opinions, beliefs and/or behaviour of the **majority** influenced by a _____.（minority 少数人）
Obedience（服从）	an _____ → you（authority figure 权威人物）	_____.（complying to the orders of an authority figure 服从权威的命令）

How to tell them apart in an exam 考试怎么区分

Ask one question: **where does the pressure come from?** 压力来自**人多** → conformity；来自**人少却改变了多数** → minority influence；来自**有职位/有权力的人** → obedience。

Where social psychology began 社会心理学的起点

- **Gustave Le Bon (1895)** — observed behaviour in **crowds**; descriptive rather than scientific.
- **Floyd Allport (1924)** — argued social psychology should use _____ methods, so claims about influence could be tested.（experimental 实验）

§2 · term Obedience — the behaviour we are explaining

ANSWERS → 课件 §6

The definition — learn it word for word 定义，一字不差地背

obedience（服从）：_____.（complying to the orders of an authority figure 服从权威人物的命令）

Two terms that explain why obeying feels normal 为什么服从像本能

hierarchical（等级制的）	A system of social organisation where there are _____ and those who follow.（leaders 领导者）
socialisation（社会化）	The process by which we learn the _____ of society through socialising agents such as parents and teachers.（rules and norms 规则与规范）

The mechanism in three steps 机制三步

1. We grow up in a **hierarchical** society — some people give instructions, others follow them.
2. **Socialisation** rewards us for obeying and corrects us for refusing.
3. By adulthood obeying is close to a _____.（habit 习惯）

Why this is worth studying 为什么值得学

The same training that makes society work — stopping at red lights, queueing, handing in homework — also explains the darkest events of the twentieth century, where ordinary soldiers, clerks and railway workers took part in systematic murder and repeated the same defence: **"I was only following orders."**

The question that started it all 一切的起点

> *How far will an ordinary person go when someone in authority tells them to hurt another person?*

Milgram's question was **not** "are these people evil?" — it was a question about the **situation**. He ran a series of experiments and then proposed **agency theory** to explain what he saw.（实验本身的细节在另一个专题页完整学习；这里只把它当作理论的证据来源）

Think-write · 想一想（3–4 行）

"I was only following orders" — is this an excuse or an explanation? Write what psychology can say about it that a court cannot.

Exam tip 考点提示

A definition question is the cheapest mark on the paper — and the one most often thrown away. **"Doing what you are told"** scores nothing; **"complying to the orders of an authority figure"** scores full marks. The word **authority** is what carries the mark.

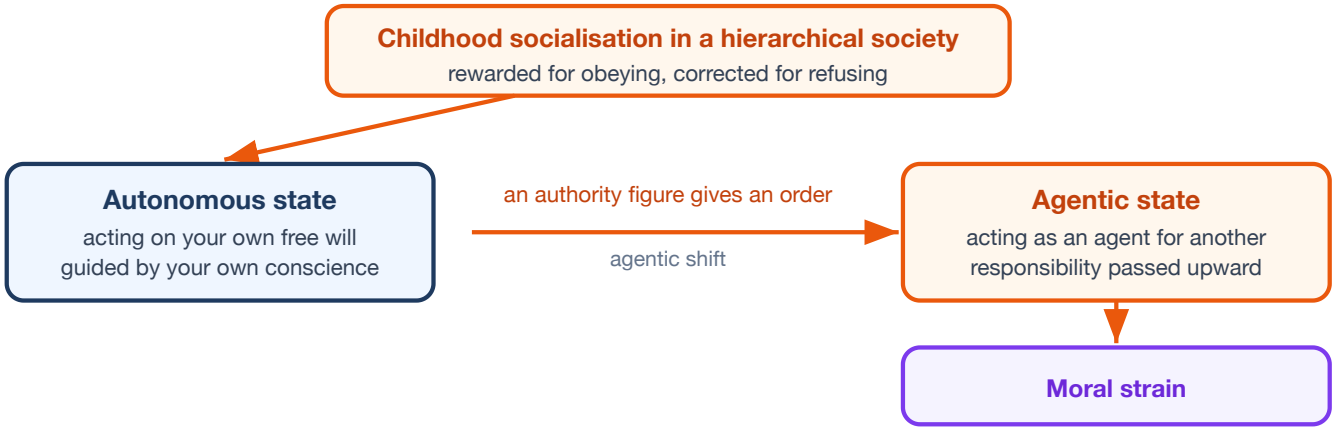
§3 · theory Agency Theory — two states of mind

ANSWERS → 课件 §7

Key terms 术语填空

autonomy 自主	Acting on one's own _____, exercising self-determination.（free will 自由意志）
agency 代理	When we act as an _____ for another, for example when we obey orders.（agent 代理人）
moral strain 道德紧张	Experiencing _____ because you are asked to do something that goes against your _____.（anxiety · moral judgement 焦虑 · 道德判断）

The model 模型图



The two states side by side 两态对照

	Autonomous state 自主态	Agentic state 代理态
Whose will? 谁的决定	_____（your own free will 自己的）	Acting for _____（someone else 别人）
Who is responsible? 谁负责	_____（you are 你自己）	_____（the authority figure 权威人物）
What does the person feel? 感受	Guided by conscience.	_____ if the order clashes with their morals.（moral strain 道德紧张）

The name of the move 这个动作叫什么

agentic shift（代理转移） — the move from the autonomous state into the agentic state.

displacement of responsibility（责任转移） — _____.（passing responsibility for your own actions to the person who gave the order 把责任交给下令的人）

人不是突然变坏，而是悄悄把"负责的人"换掉了。这是 agentic state 最核心的一句。

Why the shift is so easy 为什么这个转移很容易发生

Because socialisation has rehearsed it long before anyone gives us a harmful order: teacher says sit down, coach says run, manager says sign. The agentic state is not a rare state of mind — for most of us it is a _____ one.（well-rehearsed 反复演练过的）

§4 · eval The Evidence Milgram Used · 理论的证据

ANSWERS → 课件 §8

What happened, in four lines 实验四句话

1. Participants believed they were in a study about **learning and memory**; each one was given the role of _____.（teacher 老师）
2. They were told to give an electric shock to a _____ every time a mistake was made, increasing the shock each time.（learner 学习者）
3. The learner was in another room and was a **confederate**（同谋者）— _____ were given, but the participant believed they were.（no real shocks 没有真的电击）
4. The shock generator had **30 switches**, from 15 V to **450 V**, labelled up to "Danger: severe shock".

The two numbers you must know 必须记住的两个数字

100%	Every participant continued to _____ V.（300 V）
65%	…and _____ of participants continued all the way to _____ V.（65% · 450 V）
35%	The proportion who **refused** to continue — the number every criticism of the theory starts from.

Signs of moral strain 道德紧张的证据（填空）

What was observed 观察到的	Why it matters for the theory 为什么重要
_____（nervous laughter 紧张的笑）	如果人真的完全进入代理态、心里毫无波澜，这些反应都不该出现。正因为出现了，Milgram 才说：人不是"变成了坏人"，而是**一边照做一边承受冲突**。
sweating, trembling and _____（stuttering 口吃）	
three participants had _____（seizures 抽搐）	
in the debrief, participants said the _____, not themselves, was responsible（experimenter 实验者）	

The evidence in one sentence 证据一句话总结

Most people made the agentic shift (**65%** went to the highest shock level), but their bodies showed _____ — so the shift is real, and it is *uncomfortable*.（moral strain 道德紧张）

Beyond the laboratory 实验室之外

At the **My Lai massacre**, Lieutenant _____ and his men killed unarmed civilians; his defence was that he was **following orders**.（William Calley 威廉·凯利） Agency theory is used to explain obedience outside the laboratory too.

Think-write · 想一想

If 35% refused, the agentic shift cannot be automatic. What else — inside the person or in the situation — must be doing some of the work? Write 3–4 lines.

§5 · eval Evaluating Agency Theory — support

ANSWERS → 课件 §9

The rule for every evaluation point 评价点的写法规则

Point = what + why. 先说"理论做对了/漏掉了什么"，再给一句"**why it matters**"。只写前半句，8 分题只能拿一半的分。

Four strengths 四点支持

Strength	What it says 内容	Why it matters 为什么算支持
Research support: the numbers	In Milgram's first experiment, _____% continued to the highest shock level, so most people did make the agentic shift.（65%）	A theory is stronger when the thing it _____ is what actually happens.（predicts 预测）
Moral strain was visible	Nervous laughter, sweating, trembling, seizures — the theory predicts exactly this inner conflict.	The theory explains a detail it was _____.（not built to explain 并非专为它而设计的）
Displacement of responsibility	In the debrief, participants said the _____ was responsible, not themselves.（experimenter 实验者）	The mechanism itself was _____ by the participants.（reported 亲口说出）
Real-life support	My Lai: Lieutenant Calley killed unarmed civilians and said he was _____.（following orders 只是服从命令）	The theory explains obedience _____.（outside the laboratory 实验室之外）

Write it out · 把第一条写完整（2–3 行）

Strength: agency theory is supported by research evidence. In Milgram's first experiment…

Sentence pattern · 可套用的句式

- **Strength:** "A strength is _____; for example, _____ . This supports the theory because _____ ."
- **Applied:** "In the scenario, _____ obeyed because they were in the **agentic state**: responsibility was **displaced onto** _____ ."

Useful application 理论能用来做什么

If obedience comes from passing responsibility upwards, organisations can be designed to **hand it back**: clear rules that a harmful order can be refused, and protection for people who report one — _____ — instead of treating refusal as disobedience.（whistleblowing 举报） This matters for limiting the damage done by **malevolent authority**（恶意权威）: someone who uses their authority for harmful purposes.

§6 · eval Evaluating Agency Theory — criticisms

ANSWERS → 课件 §9

Four criticisms 四点批评（填空）

Criticism	What it says 内容	Why it matters 为什么这是个问题
It cannot explain individual differences	_____% of Milgram's participants refused to continue; one participant, _____, had grown up in Nazi Germany and refused to obey.（35% · Brandt）	If the shift were automatic this should not happen — **personality and upbringing** must be part of the explanation.
It ignores situational factors	**Latané (1981)**: obedience depends on the _____, _____ and _____ of the sources of influence.（strength 强度 · immediacy 即时性 · number 人数）	The same person obeys in one setting and _____ in another, so the setting must be explained.（refuses 拒绝）
It is reductionist	**reductionist**: explaining a complex behaviour by _____, which ignores other important factors.（isolated factors / a single cause 单一原因）	A single-cause explanation will always fit some cases badly.
Useful application	Knowing the mechanism lets organisations design protection: refusal rules and **whistleblowing** policies.	_____（understanding malevolent authority helps institutions limit the damage 理解恶意权威能帮助机构减少伤害）

Two weaknesses that point forward 两条批评预告了下一节

"It ignores the **situation**" and "it ignores **individual differences**" are the two gaps that the **factors affecting obedience** topic fills: *who the person is* and *where the order is given*. Every criticism of social power theory (pp. 9–10) is built from the same two gaps.

Write it out · 写一条完整的批评（3–4 行）

Weakness 1: agency theory cannot explain individual differences. In Milgram's study…

Weakness 2: agency theory ignores situational factors. Latané argues that…

The reductionist paragraph — ready to use 还原论那一段（可直接用）

Agency theory can be argued to be **reductionist**, because it explains a complex behaviour — obedience — using one single mechanism, the agentic shift, and leaves out culture, personality, mood and the situation. This matters because a single-cause explanation always fits some cases badly, and those cases are the ones exam questions ask about.

Self-check 自查

- ☐ I can give **two** strengths, each with a why-it-matters sentence.
- ☐ I can give **two** weaknesses, each with a why-it-matters sentence.
- ☐ I can define **reductionist** without looking.

§7 · theory Social Power Theory — five bases

ANSWERS → 课件 §11–§12

Two theories, one behaviour 两个理论，同一个行为

	Agency theory	Social power theory
Who is explained? 解释谁	_____（the person obeying 服从的人）	_____（the authority figure 下命令的人）
One sentence 一句话	"They obeyed because responsibility moved from them to the person in charge."	"They obeyed because of the _____ that person was seen to hold."（kind of power 哪种权力）

两个解释可以同时成立：一个人之所以进入代理态，*正因为*那位权威看起来很正当。评价题的高分答案会说出两者，并说明在这个情境里哪个更合适。

The theory 理论原文

social power theory — **French and Raven (1959)** identified _____ bases of power, which are said to motivate and influence behaviour.（five 五种）

The key word is **perceived**: the power does not have to be _____ — it has to be believed to be there.（real 真实的）

The five bases 五种权力（填空）

Base	Source of the power 权力来源	照做是因为…（一句话）	Example 例子
Coercive（强制权）	The ability to impose a _____.（punishment 惩罚）	_____（不听话会变糟）	A teacher can issue a detention.
Reward（奖励权）	The ability to give a _____.（reward or incentive 奖励）	_____（照做有好处）	A parent can give pocket money.
Legitimate（法定权）	An _____ position.（official / recognised 官方认可）	_____（这个位置本就该被服从）	A police officer; an elected official.
Expert（专家权）	_____ held by a credible influence.（superior knowledge / expertise 专业知识）	_____（对方比我懂）	A college professor; a car specialist.
Referent（感召权）	_____.（respect or admiration 尊敬或崇拜）	_____（我想成为/被那样的人接纳）	A celebrity; a charismatic leader.

How to identify a base in a scenario 场景里怎么判断是哪种 power

找场景里的**具体动作**，不要找形容词：有人会被罚 → coercive；有人会得到东西 → reward；有人戴制服/有头衔 → legitimate；有人说的话别人听不懂 → expert；有人被崇拜 → referent。

§8 · theory Power Depends on Context · support

ANSWERS → 课件 §13–§14

The rule 规则

The five bases are **contingent upon context**（取决于情境） — the same person holds power in one setting and _____ in the next.（none 一点也没有）

Example: a football referee holds _____ power on the field during a game, but not off the field afterwards.（legitimate 法定） Reward power only works if the target actually _____ the reward on offer.（wants 想要）

失分点：写 "the manager has legitimate power" 却不说明**在什么情境下**成立。情境一变，权力就消失——这正是评价题里 "fails to take account of context" 这条批评的来源。

Four strengths 四点支持（填空）

Strength	What it says 内容	Why it matters 为什么算支持
Organisations create obedience	Corporations and the military use **hierarchies**: senior officers hold _____ power over lower ranks, plus **reward** and _____ power.（legitimate 法定 · coercive 强制）	The theory reaches outside the laboratory and into real institutions — it may explain why **malevolent authority** is implicated in war crimes.
It can become protection	Because it says where power comes from, it can train soldiers to _____ malevolent authority and promote **whistleblowing policies**.（resist 抵抗）	A good theory is not only descriptive — it says where to intervene.
Milgram's own study fits it	The study ran at _____, a highly regarded university (legitimate power), and **Mr Williams** wore a lab coat (_____ power).（Yale 耶鲁 · expert 专家）	The same data supports a second explanation — exactly what an evaluation wants.
Two sources at once	Institution (Yale) and expertise (lab coat) acted **together**.	People rarely obey for one reason, and this theory can _____.（handle several bases at once 同时处理多种权力）

Write it out · 把 Milgram 那一条写完整（3 行）

Strength: Milgram's own study fits social power theory, because participants may have perceived…

Sentence pattern · 可套用的句式

"_____ obeyed because _____ was **perceived** to hold _____ power: _____ . In this context the power holds because _____ ."

§9 · eval Evaluating Social Power Theory — criticisms

ANSWERS → 课件 §14

Four points 四点评价（填空）

Point	What it says 内容	Why it matters 为什么这是个问题
It ignores the circumstances of the order	The theory fails to take account of the _____ in which the order is given. Latané: _____, _____ and _____ matter.（context 情境 · proximity 距离 · strength 强度 · number 人数）	The same person obeys an order shouted across the room and refuses it over the telephone, so the setting has to be part of the explanation.
It ignores individual differences	It cannot explain differences in obedience and _____; obedience and dissent occur for reasons of personality type, _____ and culture.（dissent 异议 · gender 性别）	Two people facing the same authority with the same power make _____ choices.（opposite 相反的）
It is therefore reductionist	It traces obedience back to one thing — the **perceived power** of the authority figure.	A single-cause explanation always fits some cases badly, and those cases are the ones questions ask about.
Wider issue: social control	**social control**: psychological knowledge may be used to _____ other people's behaviour.（manage or control 管理或控制）	The same knowledge that protects can also _____ — especially if coercive measures command obedience.（oppress 压迫）

Write it out · 写两条完整的批评（每条 3 行）

Weakness 1: social power theory fails to take account of the context…

Weakness 2: social power theory ignores individual differences such as…

One comparison worth memorising 值得背下来的一句对比

Both theories draw the **same two criticisms** — they ignore the **context** of the order and they ignore **individual differences** — which is why both can be called **reductionist**. Being able to say "the same weakness applies to both" is what turns a list into a conclusion.

Summary table · 两个理论一张表收口

	Agency theory	Social power theory
Core claim 核心主张	Obedience = the agentic shift; responsibility is displaced onto the authority.	Obedience = the perceived power the authority figure holds.
Key evidence 关键证据	Milgram: 65% to 450 V; visible moral strain; My Lai.	Yale setting + lab coat; hierarchies in the military and corporations.
Main weaknesses 主要批评	Cannot explain individual differences; ignores situational factors; reductionist.	Ignores the context of the order; ignores individual differences; reductionist.

§10 · exam Exam Skills — how answers are marked

ANSWERS → 课件 §16

IDEA — 回答带情境的题目

- **I — Identify:** decide which piece of psychology the scenario is about (agency theory, or one of the five bases).
- **E — Explain:** state that piece of psychology accurately, in its own terms.
- **A — Apply:** link it to the **details** — name the people, say who holds the power, say what the person actually did.

只复述理论、完全不碰情境，写得再标准也是 0 分。说*是什么*得 1 分；同一句加上*为什么重要*得 2 分。

Command words 指令词

Command word	What it asks for 要求你做什么
Outline / Describe	Say what the theory claims — accurate content, using its own terms. **No judgement needed.**
Explain	Say what it claims *and* why it works that way — one step further than describe.
Evaluate / Assess / Discuss	**Two halves:** describe the theory accurately, then judge it with evidence — strengths, weaknesses, and a conclusion.
"using…" / "with reference to the context"	The scenario is compulsory. Every point must touch a named detail of it.

How the big question splits 大题的分怎么分

- **6-mark** (one strength + two weaknesses): three developed points. Each = *what* + *why it matters*.
- **8-mark** (evaluate / assess / discuss): **half the marks for outlining the theory accurately, half for judging it**. Four paragraphs: outline → support → criticisms → conclusion.
- **A generic answer scores nothing.** An answer that could be written without reading the question — or a conclusion that never answers the question asked — stays in the middle levels.

Sentence templates · 考试句式（填空后就能用）

- **Theory + application:** "In the scenario, _____ is an authority figure, so _____ shifted into the **agentic state** and **displaced responsibility** onto them."
- **Power + context:** "_____ is **perceived** to hold _____ power because _____ — and in this context that perception is what produces obedience."
- **Strength:** "A strength is _____; for example _____ . This supports the theory because _____ ."
- **Weakness:** "A limitation is _____; in this study _____ . This weakens the theory because _____ ."
- **Conclusion:** "Overall, _____ , because _____ ."

§11 · exam Two 8-mark essay plans · 八分题提纲

Fill in, then write in full on p.14

Plan A — "Assess how well agency theory can explain obedience"

¶	What goes in it 内容	My notes 我的要点
1	**Outline**: socialisation in a hierarchical society → autonomous state → agentic shift → agentic state → displacement of responsibility → moral strain.	
2	**Support**: 65% reached the highest shock level; visible moral strain; participants blamed the experimenter; My Lai and "following orders".	
3	**Criticisms**: 35% refused and Brandt resisted (individual differences); Latané's strength / immediacy / number (situational factors); reductionist.	
4	**Conclusion** that answers the question asked: how *well*? Weigh support against criticism and say which side is stronger.	

Plan B — "Evaluate how well social power theory can account for obedience"

¶	What goes in it 内容	My notes 我的要点
1	**Outline**: French and Raven (1959) — coercive, reward, legitimate, expert, referent; perceived power gives influence over the target.	
2	**Support**: hierarchies in the military and corporations; reward power at work; legitimate power and the Holocaust.	
3	**Criticisms**: ignores individual differences (personality, gender, culture); ignores the circumstances of the order (Latané: strength, immediacy, number).	
4	**Conclusion**: how *well* does it account for obedience? Weigh it up — and say whether an **interactionist** position (person × situation) explains the evidence better.	

What separates a middle-band answer from a top-band one 中档与高档的分界

- Middle: accurate description, then a list of "a weakness is…" with no reason attached.
- Top: every point carries its **why it matters**, the scenario details are used rather than ignored, and the conclusion actually answers the question word (*how well?*).

Sentence I will reuse 我最想记住的一句

§12 · exam Practice A — short answers

Model answers → p.16

*Q1 · 2 marks — Brandon works in a warehouse. His manager instructs him to load 10 boxes onto a van by 11:00 am; Brandon completes the task. The manager then leaves for a meeting at another site and **emails** Brandon to unpack five boxes by 3:00 pm. Brandon finishes at 4:00 pm.*
Describe, using agency theory, why Brandon may have behaved in this way.

Q2 · 2 marks — Katrina is a nurse. A doctor tells her to give a patient a higher dose of medication than normal. Katrina is worried about the increase, but gives the higher dose anyway.
Describe, using agency theory, why Katrina gives the higher dose.

Q3 · 2 marks — Name the type of social power each definition describes.
*(a) The authority figure can **punish** a person for disobedience. (b) The authority figure has **superior knowledge and / or skills**.*

*Q4 · 6 marks — (a) Explain **one strength** of social power theory as an explanation of obedience.*
*(b) Explain **two weaknesses** of social power theory as an explanation of obedience.*

Before you write 动笔前先检查

☐ 每个 point 都写了 **what** 和 **why it matters** ☐ 用了术语原文 ☐ Q1 / Q2 提到了场景里的细节

§13 · exam Practice B — the 8-mark applied question

Model answer → p.17

Q5 · 8 marks — Jorge has recently bought a car. He notices an unusual noise when he drives fast. His friends hear the noise but tell him it is nothing to worry about and that he should still drive fast. Jorge is concerned, so he speaks to the car specialist at his local garage. He has known the specialist for a long time and trusts their advice. The specialist tells him to bring the car in the next day and only drive at a slow speed.

Discuss, using social power theory, why Jorge obeys the car specialist and not his friends. You must make reference to the context in your answer.

Plan the four points first 先列四点

Point	Which base / what it says 用哪种权力	Which detail of the scenario it uses 用上哪个细节
1	_____ (expert power 专家权)	
2	_____ (referent power 感召权)	
3	_____ (legitimate power 法定权)	
4	**Comparison:** why not the friends? 为什么朋友不行	

Now write it up 写成答案

Self-mark 打分自测

Tick what you produced: ☐ 4 developed points ☐ each uses a scenario detail ☐ "perceived" power explained ☐ context referenced ☐ the friends are used

Score /8: _____ If 3 or below, re-write it in full from memory tomorrow.

§14 · Brain Dump — close the book · 合上笔记盲测

10 minutes · timer on

The honest self-test 自测说明

Close the workbook. Set a 10-minute timer. Without looking back, write everything you remember. Short phrases are fine — the lines you cannot fill are exactly the topics to revisit.

A · Definitions 定义默写

obedience 服从	
moral strain 道德紧张	
agentic state 代理态	
displacement of responsibility 责任转移	
reductionist 还原论的	

B · The five bases 五种权力（只写名字 + 一句话来源）

C · Evaluation 评价（每个理论各写两条 + why it matters）

Agency theory

Social power theory

D · Two numbers and one study 数字与研究

Self-mark 自评

- ☐ Wrote **5/5 definitions** and all **5 bases** — strong, go to past papers.
- ☐ Wrote 3–4 of each — one more pass on pp. 4–10.
- ☐ Wrote fewer than 3 — re-read pp. 4–10 first, then try again tomorrow.

p.2 — Foundations

Social approach: the real or imagined presence / pressure of others.
theory = explain behaviour · **study** = test a theory · **methodology** = collect data.
Conformity: majority → you (majority). **Minority influence:** minority → majority (minority). **Obedience:** authority figure → you (complying to the orders of an authority figure).
Allport: experimental methods.

p.3 — Obedience

obedience = complying to the orders of an authority figure.
hierarchical = leaders and those who follow. **socialisation** = rules and norms of society (parents, teachers).
Step 3: obeying is close to a **habit**.

p.4 — Agency theory

autonomy = own free will · **agency** = an agent for another · **moral strain** = anxiety … against your moral judgement.
Autonomous: your own will / you are responsible. **Agentic:** for someone else / the authority figure is responsible / moral strain.
displacement of responsibility = passing responsibility for your own actions to the person who gave the order. "Well-rehearsed" state.

p.5 — The evidence

teacher / learner; the learner was a confederate; **no real shocks** were given.
100% reached 300 V; **65%** reached 450 V; 35% refused.
Signs: **nervous laughter**; sweating, trembling, **stuttering**; three **seizures**; blamed the **experimenter**.
My Lai: Lieutenant **William Calley**.

p.6 — Agency theory: support

65% continued to the highest level. A theory is stronger when what it **predicts** is what happens.
Moral strain: a detail it was **not built to explain**.
Debrief: the **experimenter** was responsible — the mechanism was **reported** by participants.
My Lai: **following orders**; explains obedience **outside the laboratory**.
Application: **whistleblowing**.

p.7 — Agency theory: criticisms

35% refused; **Brandt** (grew up in Nazi Germany) resisted.
Latané: **strength, immediacy, number**; the same person **refuses** in another setting.
reductionist = explaining a complex behaviour by isolated factors / a single cause.
Application: understanding **malevolent authority** helps institutions limit the damage.

p.8 — Five bases

French and Raven (1959) — **five** bases; power need not be **real**, only **perceived**.
Coercive = punish (不听话会变糟). **Reward** = reward / incentive (照做有好处). **Legitimate** = official / recognised position (这个位置本就该被服从). **Expert** = superior knowledge or expertise (对方比我懂). **Referent** = respect or admiration (我想成为 / 被那样的人接纳).
Bridge table: agency = the person obeying; social power = the authority figure / the **kind of power**.

p.9 — Context & support

Power is **contingent upon context**: none in the next setting; referee holds **legitimate** power on the field; reward power works only if the target **wants** the reward.
Hierarchies: **legitimate** + **coercive** power. Protection: train soldiers to **resist**. Milgram: **Yale** (legitimate) + lab coat / Mr Williams (**expert**). Handles **several bases at once**.

p.10 — Social power: criticisms

Ignores the **context** / circumstances of the order; Latané: **proximity, strength, number**.
Ignores individual differences: **dissent**, personality type, **gender**, culture — two people make **opposite** choices.
Social control: manage or control others' behaviour; the same knowledge can **oppress**.

p.13 · Q1 — Brandon (2 marks)

Brandon loaded the boxes because he was in the **agentic state** in the presence of his manager — an authority figure who could give him an instruction — and he **displaced responsibility** for the task onto the manager. When the instruction arrived **by email** instead, the manager was no longer **immediate**: without the authority figure present, Brandon slipped back towards the **autonomous state** and did not finish unpacking on time. *Each point names the state and ties it to a detail (present / away).*

p.13 · Q2 — Katrina (2 marks)

The doctor is an **authority figure** on the ward, so Katrina shifted into the **agentic state** and acted as the doctor's agent rather than on her own judgement. She experienced **moral strain** — she was worried about the dose, which shows the order went against her own moral judgement — but displaced responsibility onto the doctor and carried out the order anyway.

p.13 · Q3 — naming the bases (2 marks)

(a) **Coercive power** (punishment). (b) **Expert power** (superior knowledge). One word in the question decides which of the five it is.

p.13 · Q4 — social power theory, 1 strength + 2 weaknesses (6 marks)

Strength: it can be applied in training military personnel in **whistleblowing policies** if they believe a superior is abusing a position of **legitimate power** — which could reduce atrocities committed by soldiers carrying out orders without question. *Why:* a theory that tells you where to intervene is worth more than one that only describes.
Weakness 1: French and Raven claim obedience is a direct result of the power the authority figure is *perceived* to possess, which **ignores individual differences** of personality — for example, individuals with an internal locus of control may be more likely to **dissent** because they take personal responsibility for their actions. *Why:* two people facing the same authority make opposite choices.
Weakness 2: the theory fails to take account of the **circumstances** in which the order is given — Latané shows that **proximity, strength and number** change obedience, so the same authority giving the same order gets different results in different settings. *Why:* the setting itself must be part of any explanation.

p.14 · Q5 — Jorge (8 marks)

Expert power. The specialist has superior knowledge and expertise; Jorge believes he knows whether the noise is dangerous, so he slows down on his advice and ignores his friends, who have no such knowledge.
Referent power. Jorge has known the specialist a long time and admires his work, so he identifies with him and wants his approval — the relationship is why the advice is taken seriously.
Legitimate power. The specialist's qualifications place him in an acknowledged role about whether a car is roadworthy, so his instruction carries the weight of the position as well as of the person.
The comparison that answers the question. The friends give the same advice in the opposite direction, but hold none of these bases — no expertise, no recognised position, no admired status. **Perceived power is what separates two identical messages.**

p.15 · Brain dump — the checklist you are aiming for 自测达标清单

obedience · moral strain · agentic state · displacement of responsibility · reductionist (5 definitions) · coercive / reward / legitimate / expert / referent (5 bases) · two strengths and two weaknesses per theory, each with a why-it-matters · **65% / 35%** and Milgram's first experiment.

The last three things to check before an exam 考前最后三件事

1. Can you write the **definition of obedience** word for word? 定义是最便宜的分。
2. Can you name all **five bases** and identify each one from a one-line scenario? 五种权力是必考。
3. Does every evaluation point you write have a **why it matters** sentence? 没有 why 的评价只能拿一半分。